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**A conceptualization of state revenues and expenditures U.S.:
1952-1980**

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New School for Social Research, 1984

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A CONCEPTUALIZATION OF
STATE REVENUES AND EXPENDITURES

U.S.: 1952 - 1980

by

Ertugrul A. Tonak

April 1984

Submitted to The Graduate Faculty of Political
and Social Science of the New School for Social
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Dissertation Committee
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Abstract

The main focus of this study is the role of the state in the distribution process vis-a-vis the working class in the United States during the period 1952-1980. This focus led us to formulate and then answer a question: What is the net impact of the distributive activities of the state on the wages of the working class as a whole and that of productive workers? In order to deal with the first part of the question we proposed a concept, net tax, which is taxes paid to the state minus benefits and income received from it. The second part of the question, as manifested in the fluctuations of the rate of surplus-value, is posed by narrowing down the concept of net tax paid by labor and determining the portion of the latter paid exclusively by productive workers. The empirical findings of the dissertation concerning both the net tax paid by labor and the adjusted rate of surplus-value suggest that claiming the existence of a welfare state in the United States is highly questionable.

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